

DBIM Compliance Audit Report

Union Public Service Commission

May 2026



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1. Audit Criteria

1.1. Generic Criteria

The Generic criteria in the DBIM audit evaluates essential elements applicable to all government websites. This includes assessing colour schemes for visual consistency and readability, standardized iconography for intuitive navigation, and typography for consistency across the site. The audit examines header and footer elements, organizational branding, and appropriate image usage. It also reviews content quality and organization, search functionality effectiveness, and website responsiveness across devices. These criteria aim to ensure a consistent, accessible, and user-friendly experience on all government digital platforms. The parameters are as below:

1. **Colours** – Ensures visual consistency and proper contrast for readability and brand identity across the website.
2. **Iconography** – Verifies the use of standardized, accessible icons for intuitive navigation and information representation.
3. **Typography** – Checks for consistent and readable text formatting to enhance content accessibility and user experience.
4. **Header and Footer** – Confirms the presence of essential navigation elements and information for user orientation and site-wide access.
5. **Logo** – Ensures proper representation of organizational identity and adherence to branding guidelines.
6. **Imagery** – Verifies the appropriate use, format, and size of images to enhance content without compromising performance.
7. **Content** – Assesses the quality, accuracy, and organization of information presented on the website.
8. **Search Functionality** – Ensures an effective search mechanism for users to quickly find relevant information across the website.
9. **Performance Enhancement** – Checks for website responsiveness and optimization across various devices and screen sizes.

1.2. Ministry/Department Website Criteria

The ministry/department Website criteria focus on specific requirements for ministry/department websites. This section evaluates the information architecture and content organization unique to each ministry or department. It assesses the

implementation of user personas for targeted content delivery and scrutinizes homepage design. The audit checks for proper display of key information, including the Prime Minister's quote, and verifies compliance with government-mandated content guidelines. It also examines the implementation of privacy policies and cookie consent. These criteria ensure that each website effectively represents its ministry's identity and functions while adhering to overarching government website standards. The parameters are as below:

- 1. Information Architecture** – Evaluates the logical organization and presentation of content specific to ministry/department needs.
- 2. Identify the Ministry Persona** – Assesses the implementation of user personas for targeted content delivery and improved user experience
- 3. Homepage** – Verifies the design and content of the homepage as the primary entry point for users.
- 4. PM Quote** – Ensures proper display and authenticity of Prime Minister's quotes for credibility and relevance.
- 5. Content Sections** – Checks for the presence and proper organization of key Ministry/Department-specific information.
- 6. Mandatory Directives for Content** – Verifies compliance with government-mandated content guidelines and information disclosure requirements.
- 7. Forms** – Ensures proper development of forms to fill keyboard friendly.

Highlight		Description
A red box or highlight		Non-compliance to the criteria being tested

2. Audit Summary

	Generic Checklist
Total Checkpoints	46
Checkpoints Passed	26
Checkpoints Failed	19
Not Available	1
Pass Percentage	

3. Audit Report

3.1. Generic Checklist

The following checkpoints have been audited across the website pages. The observations are provided for identified gaps, but the Ministry may take action across the website based on the checkpoints, as applicable.

S. No.	Checklist Item	Relevant DBIM Section	Compliance	Self Assessment by Ministry
A	Colours			
1	One colour group from primary palette consisting of 1 key colour with its variants, has been selected. (all pages to be checked for compliance).	2.1	No	Yes
2	Other colours (background, cards etc.) used are from the functional palette.	2.2	No	Yes
3	Icons used in the platform use either the key colour (darkest shade) from the selected colour group or inclusive white.	3.7	No	Yes
4	Footer background is of the key colour (darkest shade) of the selected colour group.	5.6	No	Yes
B	Iconography			

5	Icons follow a consistent icon style.	3.3	No	Yes
6	Icons have been selected from the icons set provided in DBIM Toolkit, unless unavailable in the kit.	3.5	Yes	Yes
7	Icons are in PNG, SVG or WEBP format only.	3.7	Yes	Yes
8	Icon sizes are as defined in DBIM – 24x24px, 32x32px, 48x48px, 64x64px.	3.7	No	Yes
9	The correct proportion of icon is retained, and icon is not compressed or stretched.	3.7	Yes	Yes
10	When an icon is placed on an image or a banner, sufficient contrast has been maintained with its background.	3.7	Yes	Yes
C	Typography			
11	The typeface used is Noto Sans.	4.1	Yes	Yes
12	Body text is left-aligned, and table has left-aligned text, right-aligned numbers, and centre-aligned column names.	4.1.1	No	Yes
13	Capital case is not used for long sentences or paragraphs and does not include Hinglish.	4.1.1	No	Yes
14	Type scale is as defined in DBIM.	4.3.1	No	Yes
15	Text colour is as per DBIM and displays optimal contrast with background.	4.4	No	Yes
16	Button sizes are consistent with uniform padding used throughout.	4.5	Yes	Yes

17	Distinct button styles are incorporated to differentiate between button states, such as enabled, hover, focus and disabled.	4.5	No	Yes
18	Mouse hover prompts a noticeable change in clickable items.	4.5	No	Yes
D	Header and Footer			
19	Emblem has been obtained from the authorized source.	5.1	NA	Yes
20	Emblem is in proper ratio and is not scaled disproportionately.	5.1	No	Yes
21	Website naming has been done as per the organization type, like Ministry/Department.	5.2	Yes	Yes
22	Logo lockup is either in black on white background or white over dark background.	5.3	Yes	Yes
23	Generic header components like logo lockup have been chosen from DBIM based on the type of government organization.	5.4	Yes	Yes
24	All the subcomponents of the generic header are enabled and accessible on the digital platform.	5.4	Yes	Yes
25	Footer displays all the key information elements and lineage as mandated in DBIM.	5.6	No	Yes
E	Logo			
26	Correct/accurate logos have been used.	5.5	Yes	Yes
27	Logos are not scaled disproportionately.	5.5	Yes	Yes

28	All logos are in JPEG/JPG, PNG, SVG or WEBP format only.	5.5	Yes	Yes
29	Logos are less than 100 KB in size.	5.5	No	Yes
F	Imagery			
30	Background images are under 500 KB.	6.1.1	Yes	Yes
31	Banner and header images are under 500 KB.	6.1.1	Yes	Yes
32	Thumbnail images are under 100 KB.	6.1.1	No	Yes
33	High resolution images are less than 5 MB.	6.1.1	Yes	Yes
34	All images are in JPEG/JPG, PNG or WEBP format only.	6.1.1	Yes	Yes
35	Thumbnail have been provided for high resolution images along with provision to view or download the high-resolution version.	6.1.1	Yes	Yes
36	Images have been used after obtaining necessary permissions and licenses and do not have a third-party ownership watermark.	6.1.3	Yes	Yes
37	Headshot images for individuals used on the website is as defined in DBIM.	6.1.4	No	Yes
G	Content			
38	All content must be complete and up to date	A.5.6	Yes	Yes
39	The language used is free from any spelling or grammatical error.	7.1.3.3	Yes	Yes
40	Central Content Publishing System has been integrated.	7.4	No	Yes

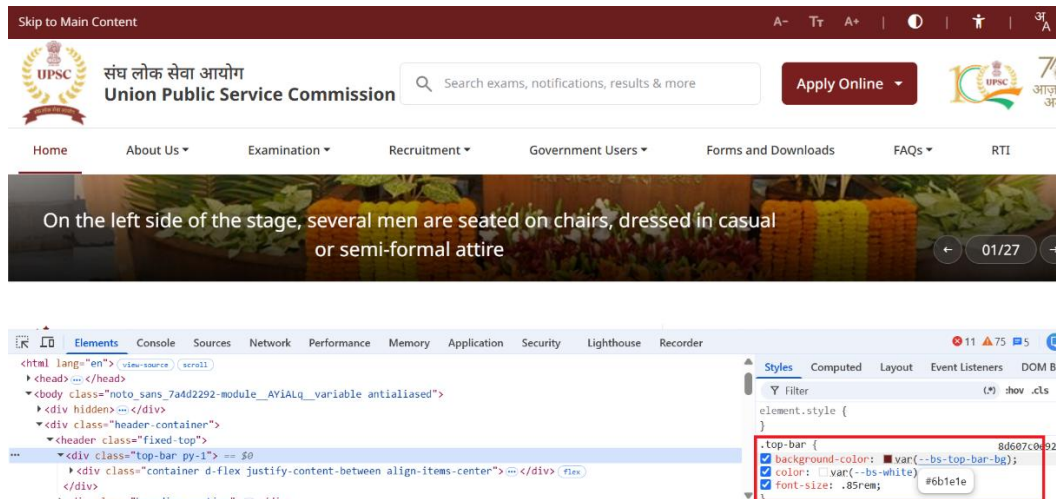
41	Clear consent for personalisation is obtained in the user's preferred language.	7.6.1	No	Yes
42	Cookie consent banner is displayed at the bottom of the page, allowing users to accept.	7.6.1	No	Yes
H	Search functionality			
43	Search is working.	9	Yes	Yes
44	Search provides relevant results across all the content of the website (HTML, PDF and Image metadata).	9	Yes	Yes
45	Relevant metadata, persona-specific tags, and keywords must be provided to improve searchability and categorization	A.5.6	Yes	Yes
I	Performance enhancement			
46	Website is responsive across multiple screen sizes.	10.2	Yes	Yes



4. Non-Compliance Observations

4.1. Generic Checklist

- **Checkpoint 1: DBIM Section – 2.1** | One colour group from primary palette consisting of 1 key colour with its variants, has been selected. (all pages to be checked for compliance)



Observations - The key colour of green colour palette used across website is #6b1e1e or #992d2a. These colours are not present in Cinnamon Red colour palette as mentioned in DBIM.

Next Step – In DBIM, refer to Figure 1 under section 2.1 – ‘Primary palette’. It is advised that hex codes of primary and functional colours across website to be as per DBIM.

Cinnamon Red

#771D1D

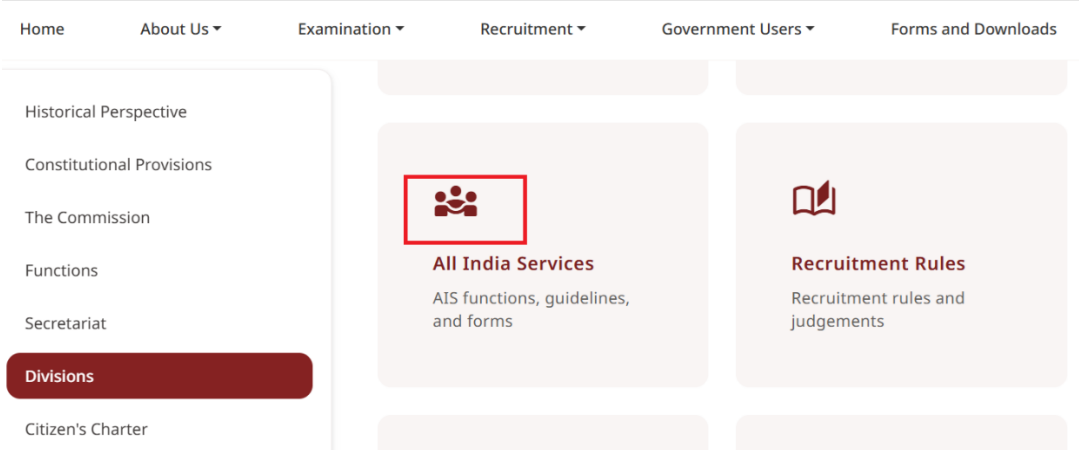
#A72626

#D75151

#FAAAAA

#FCDADA

• **Checkpoint 5: DBIM Section – 3.3 | Icons follow a consistent icon style.**



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Observations - Filled icons are used in some places, whereas line icons are used in most sections of the website, resulting in inconsistency in the icon style.

Next Step - Use a consistent icon style throughout the website, either line icons or filled icons, to maintain visual uniformity.

Checkpoint 2: DBIM Section – 2.2 | Other colours (background, cards etc.) used are from the functional palette



•

Observations - The background colour (#ffefc7) used in the figures shown above is different from colour advised under functional palette section, for background. Such observations are found in other parts of the website as well.

Next Step - In DBIM, refer Table 1 under section 2.2.1. Linen colour (#EBEAEA) is advised to be used for background colour .

• **Checkpoint 3: DBIM Section – 3.7 | Icons used in the platform used either the key colour (darkest shade) from the selected colour group or inclusive white.**

Home	About Us ▾	Examination ▾	Recruitment ▾	Government Users ▾	Forms and Downloads	FAQs
NAME OF POST		PLUG-IN FOR DOWNLOAD				
Portable Document Format (PDF) files		 Adobe Acrobat Reader				
Word files		 Word Viewer (in any version till 2003)				
Excel files		 Excel Viewer 2003 (in any version till 2003)				
PowerPoint presentations		 PowerPoint Viewer 2003 (in any version till 2003)				

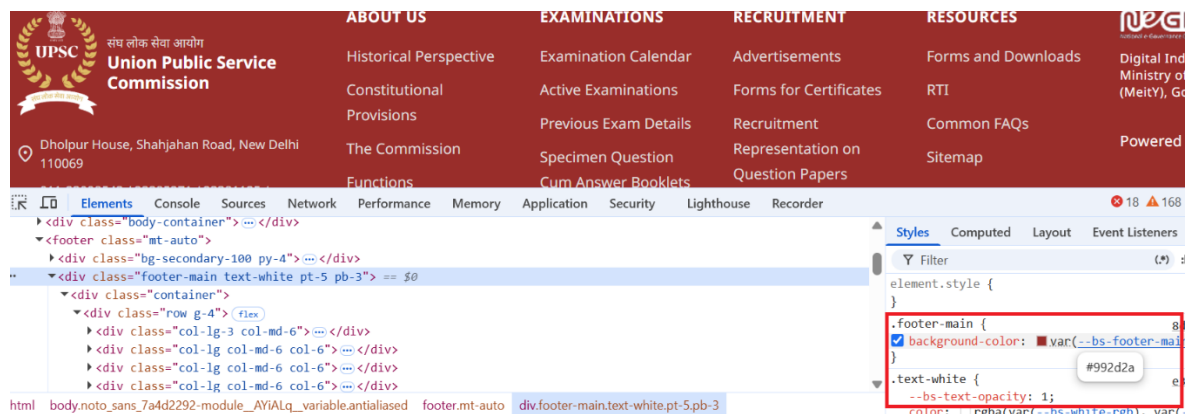
Observations - The icons shown here is not in the key colour (darkest shade) of the selected colour group.

Next Step - Refer to DBIM section 3.7 – ‘Mandatory Checklist’. It is recommended that all icons must be in the key colour (darkest shade) of the selected colour group or inclusive white.

- **Checkpoint 4: DBIM Section – 5.6 | Footer background is of the key colour (darkest shade) of the selected colour group.**

Observations - The footer background colour (#992d2a) is not key colour (darkest shade) of the selected colour group from the primary palette.

Next Step – In DBIM, refer to section 5.6. It is required to select the darkest colour from the selected primary group palette.



- **Checkpoint 8: DBIM Section – 3.7** | Icon sizes are as defined in DBIM – 24x24px, 32x32px, 48x48px, 64x64px



Observations - The size of icons highlighted in above screenshots are incorrect. More observations are found in the other parts of the website where the size of icons is incorrect.

Next Step – In DBIM, refer to section 3.4 – ‘Icons Size’. It is required to use each icon in PNG, WEBP, and SVG formats in the mentioned 4 sizes (24x24px, 32x32px, 48x48px, 64x64px).

- **Checkpoint 12: DBIM Section – 4.1.1** |Body text is left-aligned, and table have left aligned text, right-aligned numbers, and centre-aligned column names.

Forms & Download

A collection of official UPSC forms and documents needed for recruitment and verification.

Search by Form or Document Name

NAME	SIZE	DOCUMENT(S)
Sample affidavit for name	378.26 KB	View Document →

Observations – Table columns names are not centre aligned, and numbers are not right aligned. This is observed in all of the tables of the website.

Next Step – In DBIM, refer to Section 4.1.1 – ‘Application/Usage’. It is required to centre align the table columns and right align the serial number.

- **Checkpoint 13 – DBIM Section 4.1.1** |Capital case is not used for long sentences or paragraphs and does not include Hinglish

Archived Results

Status of Recruitment Cases (Advertisement-wise)

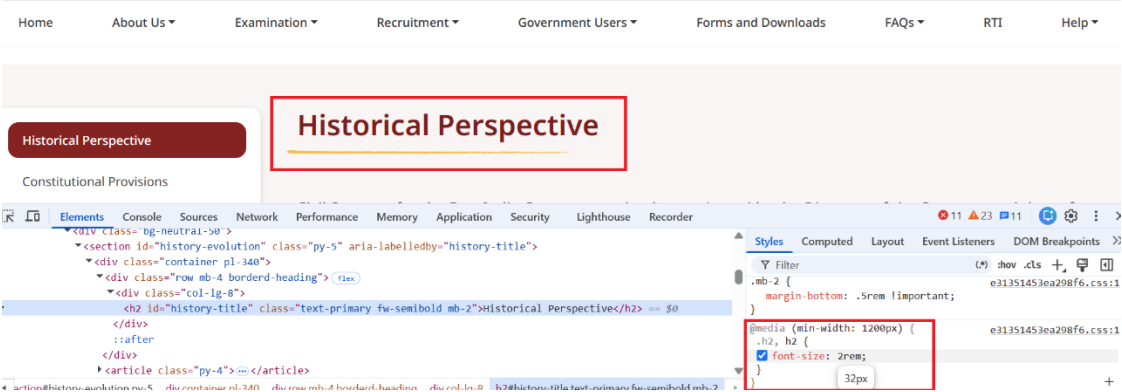
Search by title or advertisement

ADVERTISEMENT NUMBER	VACANCY NUMBER	NAME OF POST	DOCUMENTS	SIZE	DATE OF UPLOAD
No documents available.					

Observations – In the ‘Document’ section, the text has been presented in capital letters.

Next Step – In DBIM, refer to Section 4.1.1 – ‘Application/Usage’. It is recommended to avoid using capital case for long sentences or paragraphs, as this may impact readability.

- **Checkpoint 14 – DBIM Section 4.3.1** | Type scale is as defined in DBIM



Observations – It is observed that for the heading used above has a font size of heading is 32px which is not as per the DBIM guideline.

Next Step – In DBIM, refer to Section 4.4. Headings should follow the defined scale types—**h1**, **h2**, or **h3**—with corresponding font sizes of **36**, **24**, and **20** respectively. It is required to adhere to these specifications to ensure consistency in typography across the website.

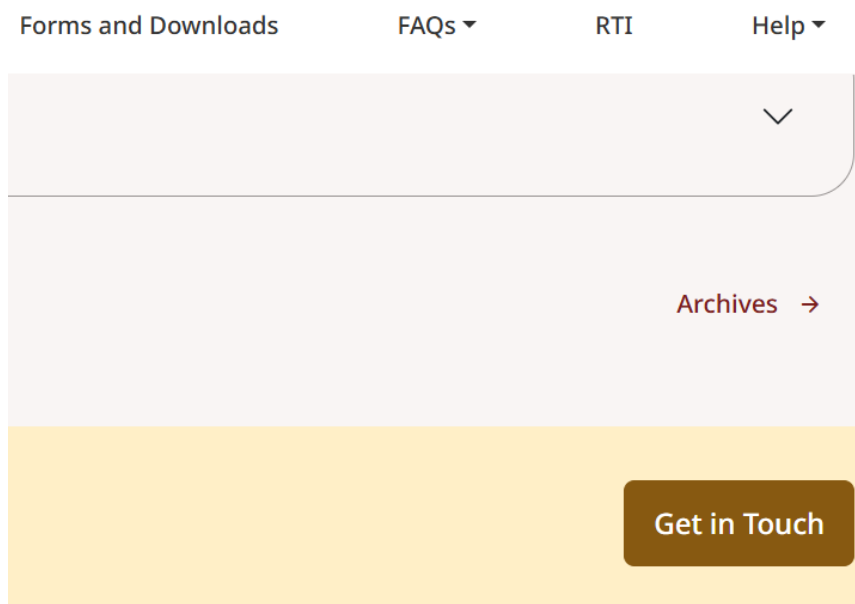
- **Checkpoint 15 – DBIM Section 4.4 | Text colour is as per DBIM and displays optimal contrast with background.**

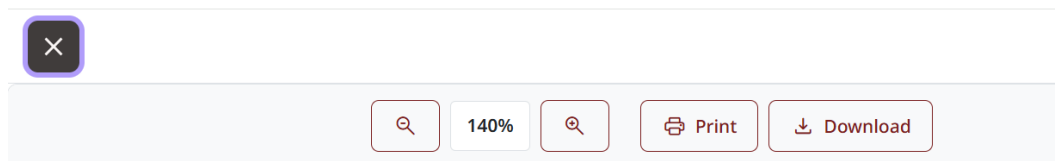


Observations – It is observed that the background colour is #f9f5f4 and text colour is #403c3b, however as per DBIM guideline shade 1 or 2 from the primary colour palette should be used instead.

Next Step – In DBIM, refer to Section 4.4. It is required to provide an optimal contrast with the background.

- **Checkpoint 17 & 18 (respectively): DBIM Section – 4.5**
 - Distinct button styles are incorporated to differentiate between button states, such as enabled, hover, focus and disabled.
 - Mouse hover prompts a noticeable change in clickable items.





General mistakes in Conventional (Descriptive) Papers

Observations – It was observed that the buttons do not exhibit any visual changes on hover and on clicking the button, border highlight is not the different tone.

Next Step - In DBIM, refer to Figure 19 under section 4.5 – ‘Other Considerations’. It is required to use a different border colour when the button is clicked. Also, when hovering over the buttons, there should be a noticeable change, like making its colour slightly darker. It is also important to ensure that all the functional icon work as intended.

- **Checkpoint 19: DBIM Section – 5.6** | Emblem has been obtained from the authorized source.

Observations – Unable to assess this checkpoint’s compliance.

Next Step – In DBIM, refer to section 5.1. It is recommended to provide supporting evidence to facilitate the assessment of the checkpoint’s compliance.

- **Checkpoint 20: DBIM Section – 5.1** | Emblem is in proper ratio and is not scaled disproportionately.
- **Observations** – No emblem is used in the header section of the website.

Next Step – As per Section 5.1 of the DBIM guidelines, it is recommended to include the Emblem on the website.

- **Checkpoint 25: DBIM Section – 5.6** | Footer displays all the key information elements and lineage as mandated in DBIM.



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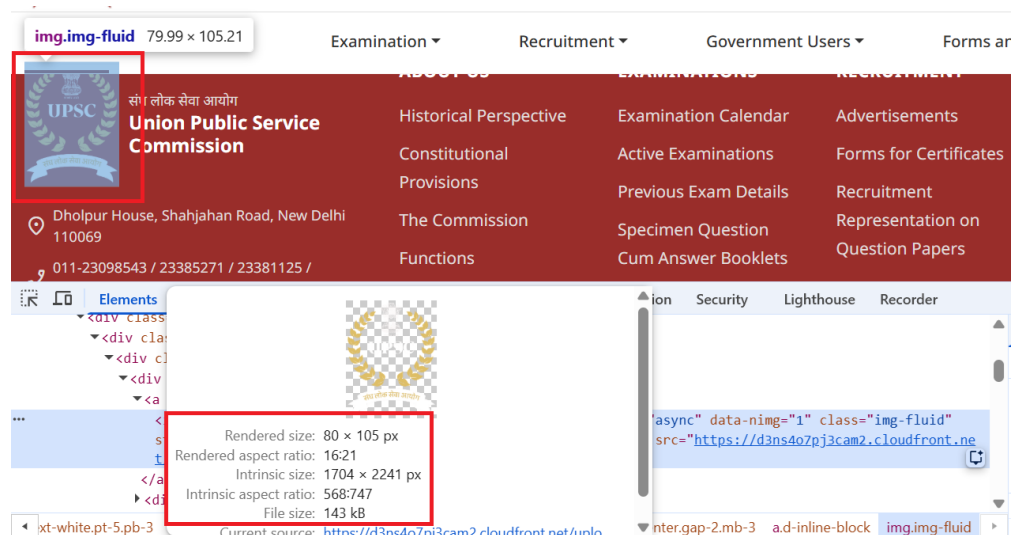
Powered by 

[Help](#) • [Contact Us](#) • [Web Information Manager](#) • [Disclaimer](#) • [Website Policies](#) • [Privacy Policy](#)

Observations – Archives, Website Policy, Related Links and Feedback are not present in the footer.

Next Step - In DBIM, refer to section 5.6 – ‘Footer’. Link to the Website Policy, Related Links and Feedback section must be added.

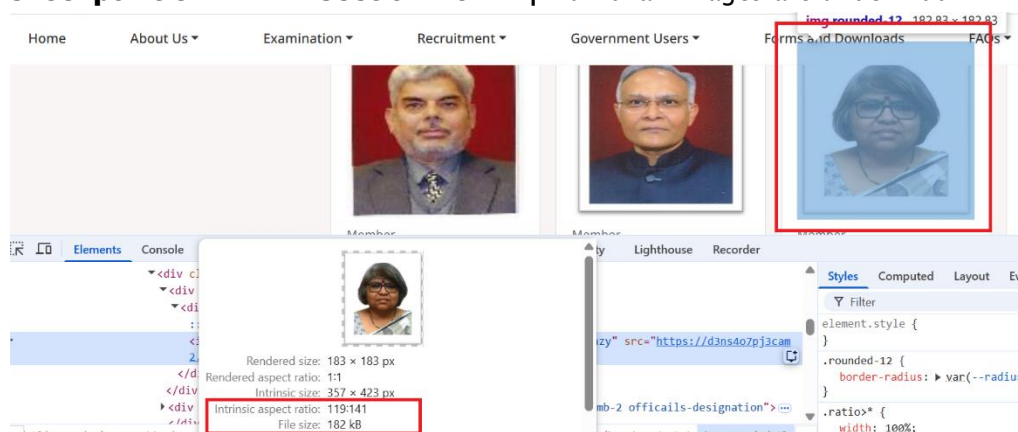
- **Checkpoint 29: DBIM Section – 5.5 |** Logos are less than 100 KB in size.



Observations – The logo highlighted in the figure exceeds 100 KB.

Next Step - In DBIM, refer to 5.5 Logo Usage Guidelines from DBIM. It is recommended that logos must less than 100 KB in size.

- **Checkpoint 32 - DBIM Section – 6.1.1 |**Thumbnail images are under 100 KB.



Observations – The thumbnail image is more than 100 KB for the highlighted images.

Next Step – In DBIM, refer to section 6.1.1 – ‘File Sizes’. It is recommended to keep thumbnail images to less than 100 KB in size.

- **Checkpoint 37 - DBIM Section – 6.1.4** | Headshot images for individuals used on the website is as defined in DBIM.

 As on 30/04/2026



Member

Dr. Dinesh Dasa

Date of Birth
29/03/1974

Date from which holding the Post
29/09/2023 (FN)

Date of Retirement as Chairman/Member
28/09/2029



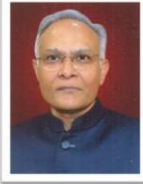
Member

Shri Sheel Vardhan Singh

Date of Birth
26/08/1963

Date from which holding the Post
15/01/2024 (FN)

Date of Retirement as Chairman/Member
25/08/2028



Member

Shri Sanjay Verma

Date of Birth
28/01/1965

Date from which holding the Post
01/02/2024 (FN)

Date of Retirement as Chairman/Member
27/01/2030

Observations – The headshots of individuals must always be on a white background, with individuals looking into the camera.

Next Step – In DBIM, refer to section 6.1.4 – ‘Headshots’. It is required to provide a white background for headshot of individuals, maintaining a ratio of 1:1.

- **Checkpoint 40 - DBIM Section – 7.4** | Central Content Publishing System has been integrated.



Observations – The first content of ‘Top Banner carousel’ is not integrated with CCPS.

Next Step – In DBIM, refer to section A 4 – ‘UI Design and Homepage’. It is required to ensure CCPS integration.

- **Checkpoint 41 - DBIM Section – 7.6.1** | Clear consent for personalisation is obtained in the user’s preferred language.

Observations – It has been observed cookie consent banner is not displayed at the bottom of the page. So clear consent for personalisation is not obtained in the user’s preferred language.

Next Step – In DBIM, refer to section 7.6.1 – ‘Personalisation Content’. The consent must be presented in the user’s preferred language prior to collecting any data for personalization

- **Checkpoint 42 - DBIM Section – 7.6.1** | Cookie consent banner is displayed at the bottom of the page, allowing users to accept, reject or customize their cookie preferences

Observations – It has been observed cookie consent banner is not displayed at the bottom of the page.

Next Step – In DBIM, refer to section 7.6.1 – ‘Personalisation Content’. It is recommended to provide cookie consent banner at the bottom of the page, allowing users to accept, reject or customize their cookie preferences.



Harmonization of Government Digital Footprint

Harmonizing of digital footprint is required to ensure a unified and standardized user experience across its various websites and applications. Focus is on establishing clear guidelines for the use of colours, icons, imagery, typography, and search functionalities, ensuring consistency and coherence.

Additionally, it emphasizes the importance of performance optimization and adherence to policies, striving to create a seamless and intuitive interface for citizens. By standardizing these elements, the initiative aims to enhance accessibility, improve user satisfaction, and present a cohesive digital presence that reflects the government's commitment to efficiency and modernization.

For DBIM Compliance, the respective Ministry/Department needs to give self-certification. The website accessibility audit and GIGW Certification would be conducted by the Standardisation Testing and Quality Certification (STQC) Directorate to ensure that government websites comply with the prescribed accessibility standards and guidelines.

DBIM Toolkit is available at: <https://dbimtoolkit.digifootprint.gov.in>